

TidyTuesday Week 38

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Monday 14th September, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the show where we throw two economic strangers into a room, make them regress against each other, and act shocked when they have chemistry. This week's blind date was a real barn-burner: the All-Transactions House Price Index for Oxnard-Thousand Oaks-Ventura, California, meets Financial Business Gross Fixed Investment in Nonresidential Equipment, Software, and Structures – a series so beloved it scores a popularity of 1 out of a possible universe, and which was so committed to the bit that it got itself discontinued in 2017. Truly the kind of matchup you dream about.

And the raw regression? Oh, be still my beating heart. An R-squared of 0.87. An F-statistic in the four digits. A p-value with so many zeros after the decimal point I briefly wondered if my keyboard was stuck. If you took this number at face value, you'd conclude that Ventura County home prices and the equipment-buying habits of financial firms are practically the same phenomenon wearing two different hats. Case closed, Nobel prize incoming, someone call the newspapers.

Except, of course, this is exactly the trap this whole project exists to faceplant into. Both of these series are long-lived numbers that mostly go up over the decades, and when you make two things-that-go-up sit next to each other, they will hold hands regardless of whether they've ever actually met. So we stripped out each series' own march-of-time trend and re-ran it. The R-squared face-planted from a dizzying 0.87 all the way down to 0.23, and the constant term collapsed to essentially zero with a p-value of 0.9999999999 – which is statistics-speak for "yeah, that was mostly the trend, buddy." There's still a faint whiff of a leftover relationship in the detrended version (the slope stayed significant, so I won't pretend it's completely dead), but it's a shadow of the grand romance the raw numbers were selling.

As always, the mandatory disclaimer, which I will keep repeating until I'm blue in the face: these are randomly paired series with no causal story, no theoretical grounding, and absolutely nothing rigorous behind them. Spurious correlation isn't the exception here – it's the house specialty, the whole menu, the reason we get out of bed. This week's headliner was a textbook trend-mirage that mostly evaporated once we took away its shared drift, and that's precisely the kind of dunk this project lives for. See you next week for another thrilling episode of Two Graphs That Have Never Spoken.

2 Date: 2026-09-14

Series ID: ATNHPIUS37100Q

This series is titled All-Transactions House Price Index for Oxnard-Thousand Oaks-Ventura, CA (MSA) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index 1995:Q1=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1976-04-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01. The popularity of this series is 6.

Series ID: FBGFIEQ027S

This series is titled Financial business; gross fixed investment, nonresidential equipment, software, and structures, Flow (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted Annual Rate. The observation start date is 1946-10-01 and the observation end date is 2017-10-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_FBGFIEQ027S	R-squared:	0.870			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.869			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	1103.			
Date:	Mon, 14 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	5.84e-75			
Time:	17:07:08	Log-Likelihood:	-1926.0			
No. Observations:	167	AIC:	3856.			
Df Residuals:	165	BIC:	3862.			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	1.341e+04	3837.676	3.493	0.001	5829.236	2.1e+04
value_fred_ATNHPIUS37100Q	745.7296	22.457	33.207	0.000	701.389	790.070
Omnibus:	1.131	Durbin-Watson:	0.039			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.568	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.803			
Skew:	-0.148	Prob(JB):	0.669			
Kurtosis:	3.165	Cond. No.	341.			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

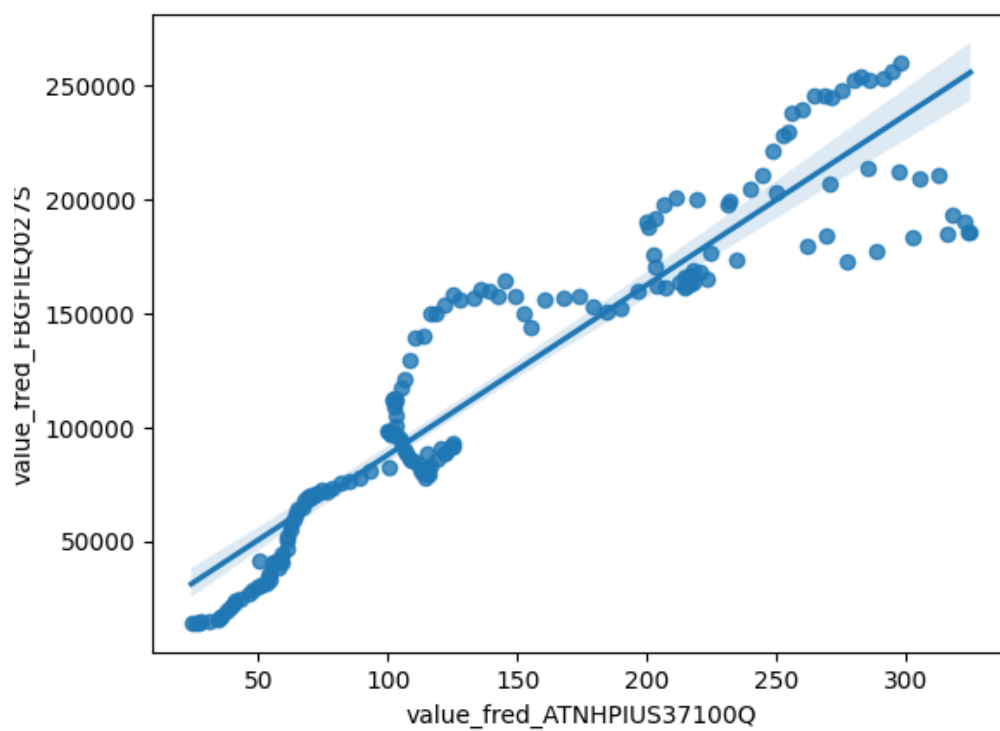


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-14

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_FBGFIEQ027S_detrended	R-squared:	0.233
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.228
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	50.05
Date:	Mon, 14 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	4.06e-11
Time:	17:07:08	Log-Likelihood:	-1814.4
No. Observations:	167	AIC:	3633.
Df Residuals:	165	BIC:	3639.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-1.573e-09	985.135	-1.6e-12	1.000	-1945.095	1945.095
value_fred_ATNHPIUS37100Q_detrended	197.7479	27.952	7.075	0.000	142.559	252.937

Omnibus:	3.074	Durbin-Watson:	0.100
Prob(Omnibus):	0.215	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.616
Skew:	-0.248	Prob(JB):	0.270
Kurtosis:	3.361	Cond. No.	35.2

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

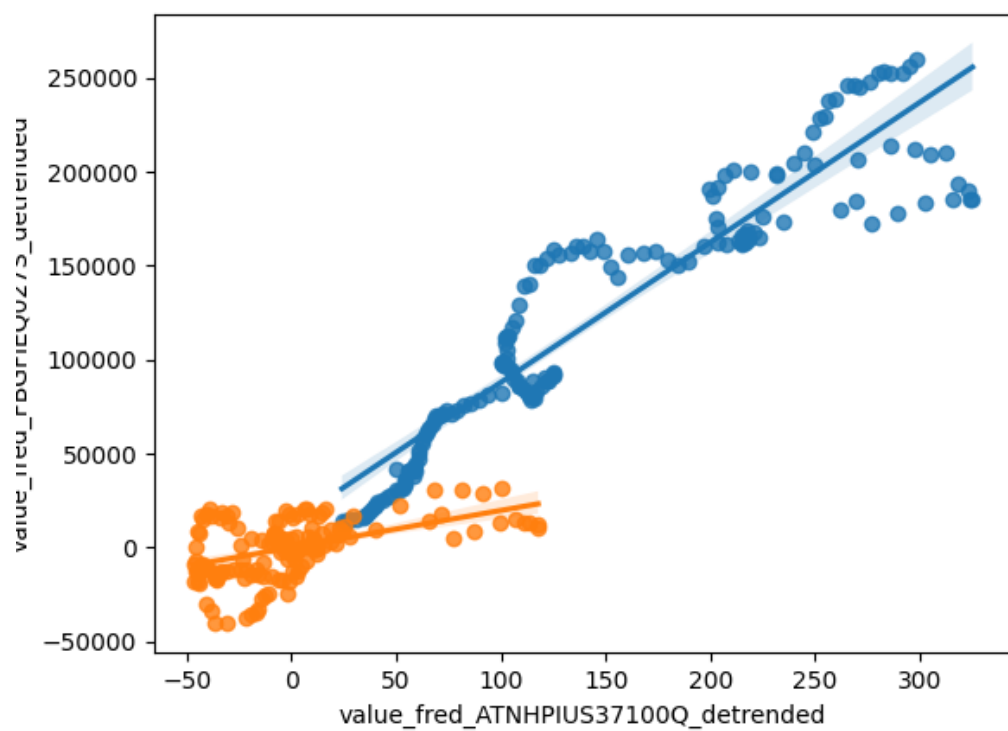


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-14